

Image Processing

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Q.1) What is Digital Image Processing? Explain the application of DIP.

→ Digital Image Processing (DIP) is the technique of improving or modifying an image using a computer so that useful information can be obtained from it.

- In DIP, an image is treated as a digital signal (Pixel) & various operations like enhancement, restoration, compression, & analysis are applied.

- The most common applications of digital image processing are

(I) Medical field - X-ray, MRI, CT Scan Analysis

(II) Satellite imaging - Weather forecasting & remote sensing

(III) Traffic control - Vehicle & number plate detection

(IV) Biometrics - Identity verification

(V) Entertainment - Photo editing & video processing

Q2) Describe the Fundamental Steps in Digital Image Processing

→ (i) Image Acquisition: Image is captured using a camera or sensor & converted into digital form.

(ii) Image Enhancement: Image quality is improved by adjusting brightness, contrast, or sharpness.

(iii) Image Restoration: Noise & blur are removed using mathematical methods.

(iv) Color Image Processing: Color information is used to analyze & enhance images.

(v) Image Compression: Image size is reduced for easy storage & fast transmission.

(vi) Morphological Processing: Shape & Structure information of objects is extracted.

(vii) Image Segmentation: Image is divided into meaningful regions or objects.

Q.3) Brief about human eye structure.

→ The human eye works like a camera & acts as an image sensing device

- Main parts of the human eye are:

- (i) Cornea - Transparent front part that allows light to enter the eye.
- (ii) Iris - Controls the amount of light entering the eye.
- (iii) Pupil - Small opening through which light enters.
- (iv) Lens - Focuses the light onto the retina.
- (v) Retina - Inner layer where image is formed & converted into signals.
- (vi) Rods - Help in vision under low light (black & white)
- (vii) Optic nerve - Carries signal from retina to the brain.

Q.5) Write a short note on Image Sampling & Quantization.

→ Image Sampling & Quantization are the two basic steps used to convert an analog image into a digital image.

- Image Sampling:

- image Sampling is the process of converting a continuous image into discrete spatial coordinates (pixels)
- It decides the spatial resolution of the image.

more sampling → more pixels → better image quality
less sampling → loss of image details

- Image Quantization

- Image quantization is the process of converting continuous intensity values into finite gray levels.
It decides the intensity resolution of the image.

more gray levels → smoother image
fewer gray levels → distortion & false contours

Q) What is Filtering? What do you understand by the term Spatial Filtering?

- Filtering is a process used in image processing to modify pixel values to achieve tasks like; noise removal, smoothing & edge enhancement.
- It works by applying a filter/mask to the image to change pixel values.

★ Spatial Filtering

- Spatial Filtering means applying a filter directly on image pixels in the spatial domain.

- General formula:

$$g(x, y) = \sum_{s=-a}^a \sum_{t=-b}^b w(s, t) \cdot f(x+s, y+t)$$

where

$f(x, y)$ = input image

$g(x, y)$ = output image

$w(s, t)$ = filter mask

$(2a+1) \times (2b+1)$ = mask size (e.g., 3×3)

Input Image

a	b	c
d	e	f
g	h	i

← →

Mask

1	1	1
1	1	1
1	1	1

Output pixel = average of all 9 pixels.

Q.) Write a short note on smoothing filters.

→ Smoothing filters are low pass filters used to reduce noise & make the image look softer by decreasing intensity changes.

— How They Work:

- These filters replace each pixel with a value based on its neighbouring pixels, usually the average.
- This removes small unwanted details & produces a smooth image.

— Median Filter (Non-Linear Smoothing)

- Another imp smoothing filter is the median filter, where the central pixel is replaced by the median of neighbouring pixels.

— Uses of Smoothing Filters:

- Noise reduction
- Smoothing satellite or medical images
- Blurring sensitive regions
- Reducing small background patterns
- Cleaning binary images.

Q) Write a short note on Sharpening Filters.

- Sharpening Filters are high-pass spatial filters used to highlight edges, boundaries, & fine details in an image.
- They work by enhancing regions where intensity changes quickly, which typically represent edges or important features.
 - Sharpening is commonly used to improve image clarity or to restore details lost due to smoothing.

→ How Sharpening Filters Work: -

- Sharpening Filters increase the contrast between a pixel & its neighbours.
- Unlike smoothing (which reduces differences), Sharpening amplifies differences.

→ Purpose of Sharpening:

- Edge enhancement
- Highlighting object boundaries
- Making images look clearer
- Extracting fine details
- Restoring blurred
- Improving visual quality of photographs or medical images.

Q.) Explain the model of image degradation & reconstruction with a diagram?

→ The image degradation & reconstruction model explain how an Original Image becomes blurred or noisy & how we try to restore it back using mathematical filters.

— Image Degradation Model

- $f(n, y)$ represents the original image
- The image passes through a degradation system
- $h(n, y)$ represent the blur function
- $\eta(n, y)$ represent noise added during transmission
- Due to blur & noise the output becomes a degraded image $g(n, y)$

— Image Reconstruction (Restoration) Model

- $g(n, y)$ (degraded image) is given as input to a restoration filter
- $R(n, y)$ represents the restoration filter (Inverse filter)
- The aim of restoration is to remove blur & noise as much as possible.
- The output is the restored image.

(Q) Explain the color Image Compression

→ Color Image Compression is the process of reducing the size of a color image by removing unnecessary or repeated information while keeping the visual quality acceptable.

- Since color images contain three components (R, G, B) they require more storage than grayscale image, so compression becomes essential.

→ Steps in Color Image Compression:

- (I) Convert the image from RGB to YCbCr
- (II) Downsample the color components (Cb & Cr)
- (III) Apply a transform (like DCT in JPEG)
- (IV) Quantize the transform values
- (V) Encode the quantized values
- (VI) Apply entropy coding (Huffman/Arithmetic)
- (VII) Get the compressed image

→ Types of Color Image Compression:

(I) Lossless Compression

- No loss in image quality
- Used for medical img, technical drawings
- Eg: LZW, PNG, GIF, Huffman
- Used when accuracy is imp.

(II) Lossy Compression

- Slight quality loss but much higher compression ratio
- Used in photos, videos
- Eg: JPEG, WebP, MP3, MP4

(Q.) What is data compression?

- Data compression is the process of reducing the size of data so that it takes less storage space & can be transmitted faster.
- It removes unnecessary or repeated information while keeping the imp. information intact.

→ Types of Data Compression:

→ How Compression Works:

- Removes repeated patterns → dictionary coding (LZW)
- Removes unnecessary bits → entropy coding (Huffman/Arithmetic)
- Removes less important img details → transform coding (DCT/JPEG)

Explain the color fundamentals.

- Color fundamentals deal with the basic concepts of color, how human perceive color, & how color information is represented in digital images.
- Understanding color fundamentals is imp for color img processing, compression & enhancement.

→ Properties of Color:

- Color is described using three basic properties -

- a) Hue - Represents the actual color (red, green, blue etc)
- b) Saturation - Represents the purity or richness of a color
- c) Intensity - Represents the amount of light.

→ Human Color Perception:

The human eye can distinguish colors due to special cells in the retina called cones.

There are three types of cones:

Red-sensitive cones	Green Sensitive cones
Blue sens. cones	

→ Color Modes:

color models are mathematical ways to represent colors -

- RGB - Used in displays & cameras
- CMY/CMYK - used in printers
- HSV/HSI - used in image processing
- YCbCr - Used in compression & video systems.

Q.) Explain the Arithmetic Coding with an example.

- • Arithmetic Coding is a lossless data compression technique that represents an entire message as a single decimal number between 0 & 1.
- Instead of assigning fixed bit codes to each symbol (like Huffman) arithmetic coding encodes the whole message in one interval.

Q) Write a short note on Erosion & Dilation

- Erosion & Dilation are the two basic operations in morphological image processing.
- They are mainly used on binary images & are based on the shape of a small matrix called the structuring element (SE)

A) Erosion:

erosion shrinks or thins the objects in an image. It removes pixels from the boundaries of objects.

Diagram

— Effect:

- object become smaller
- small noise is removed

B) Dilation grows or expands the objects in an image. It adds pixels to the boundaries of objects.

Diagram

— Effect:

- Object become larger
- Fills small holes

Uses of Erosion & Dilation

- Noise removal
- Filling small gaps
- Separating or connecting objects
- Preparing image for segmentation
- Shape analysis

Q) Write a short on opening & closing.

- Opening & Closing are morphological operations derived from erosion & dilation.
- They are used to remove noise, smooth object boundaries & improve object shapes in binary images.

(A) Opening — is the process of erosion followed by dilation using the same structuring element.

$$\text{Opening} = (A \ominus B) \oplus B$$

Effect:

- Removes small objects & noise
- Breaks thin connection
- Smooths object boundaries

(B) Closing — is the process of dilation followed by erosion using the same structuring element.

$$\text{Closing} = (A \oplus B) \ominus B$$

Q) What is thresholding? Explain global thresholding.

→ Thresholding is an image segmentation technique used to separate objects from the background based on pixel intensity values.

Suppose;

- we choose a threshold value (T)
- pixels above $T \rightarrow$ object
- pixels below $T \rightarrow$ background

After thresholding, the image usually becomes a binary image (black & white).

→ Global Thresholding is a method where one single threshold value (T) is used for the entire image.

Steps;

- choose a threshold value T
- compare every pixel with T
- if pixel $\geq T \rightarrow$ assign white (object)
- if pixel $< T \rightarrow$ assign black (background)

— Example:

Assume threshold $T = 100$

pixel value	Result
120	object (white)
90	Background (black)
150	object (white)
60	Background (black)

So the img is separated into object & background.